COPILOT STUDIO LIFECYCLE · CAT HIGHLIGHTS · STANDARDS & PRACTICES

Agent Skills & Tooling

Start with the Copilot Studio agent lifecycle, then explore featured CAT tools, community contributions, and the standards and practices behind agent skills.

Microsoft-published · 132 | MIT licensed · 131 | Catalog refreshed on 5 Oct 2026

105 skills | 24 MCP | 5 reference

Copilot Studio agent lifecycle

Copilot Studio Plugin preview skills that create, clone, extend, sync, publish and permanently delete Copilot Studio agents and their local PAC CLI workspaces. They are agent lifecycle actions, not install surfaces and not MCP setup. Delete Agent permanently deletes a cloud agent and cannot be undone; Publish Agent makes the current cloud draft live. MCP servers documentation and Reconfigure setup/portability guidance are in Standards & Practices below; neither is runnable.

Row = Copilot Studio agent lifecycle · Columns = CREATE & CLONE → EXTEND → SYNC → PUBLISH & DELETE. Purpose badges describe global lifecycle intent, not the column.

Agent lifecycle	CREATE & CLONE	EXTEND	SYNC	PUBLISH & DELETE
Copilot Studio Agent Lifecycle Create, clone, extend, sync, publish and permanently delete Copilot Studio agents (Copilot Studio Plugin preview skills)	**Create Agent ↗** AUTHOR Create a new Copilot Studio agent and PAC-connected local workspace, optionally adding instructions, skills, tools, knowledge and settings; it never publishes. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill **Clone Agent ↗** BUILD Clone an existing Copilot Studio agent into a new local PAC CLI workspace; it reads the cloud agent and writes local files only. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill	**Add Skill ↗** DEPLOY Acquire an existing skill from a local file or CAT gallery and optionally import it into a Copilot Studio CLI-agent workspace. Publishing is separate. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill **Add Knowledge ↗** AUTHOR Add a public website, SharePoint, OneDrive or uploaded-file knowledge source to a locally cloned Copilot Studio agent by writing knowledge YAML; push and publish are separate. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill	**Pull Agent ↗** BUILD Pull remote Copilot Studio agent changes into an existing PAC CLI workspace, merging into local files; it never pushes or publishes. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill **Push Agent ↗** DEPLOY Push local changes from a PAC CLI workspace to the Copilot Studio agent's cloud draft, pulling first; it never publishes. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill	**Publish Agent ↗** DEPLOY Publish an existing Copilot Studio agent, making its current cloud draft live for users who can access it; it does not upload, pull or push. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill **Delete Agent ↗** OPERATE DESTRUCTIVE: permanently delete a Copilot Studio agent from the cloud after an exact typed confirmation. Irreversible; local workspace files are not deleted. Copilot Studio Plugin · Skill

CAT featured highlights

CAT highlights are a curated selection, not a claim of CAT authorship or gallery origin. Actual sources are shown on each card.

Skill Recorder ↗ AUTHOR

Desktop app

Desktop app: record a task, review the Copilot analysis, then generate a reusable Agent Skill or Automation.

microsoft/skill-recorder

Open source · GitHub ↗

MCS Assistant ↗ AUTHOR

Experimental plugin

Experimental plugin for creating, editing, validating and migrating classic Copilot Studio agents to the new experience.

microsoft/copilot-studio-plugin

Experimental classic-to-modern Copilot Studio migration: Experimental plugin for creating, editing, validating, and migrating classic Copilot Studio agents to the new experience.

Copilot Studio Plugin · skill · Author

Open source · GitHub ↗

MCP App UI ↗ AUTHOR

Skill · Generate MCP App UI

Create interactive widgets for MCP tool output.

microsoft/power-platform-skills/plugins/mcp-apps/skills/generate-mcp-app-ui · Skill

Power Platform Skills · skill · Author

Open source · GitHub ↗

More from CAT Community-contributed

Community-contributed · published through the CAT gallery's contribution process

Metadata and build checks are documented; review each skill's prerequisites before use.

Source: microsoft/cat-agent-skills · microsoft.github.io · external gallery

Contribution process and documented checks · GitHub ↗

Explore the CAT gallery ↗

Supporting resources below and the external gallery remain visible across search and filters.

Reference **Standards & Practices** — context that informs how you build (not installable skills; excluded from the skill count)

The Agent Skills standard

The open authoring format — SKILL.md, packaging & portability.

Agent Skills open standard

The open authoring format for skills: SKILL.md structure, packaging, and portability.

Setup & host guidance

Install, run, secure & govern the skills across hosts.

Power Platform Skills: setup & host guide

How to install, run, secure and govern the skills across supported hosts.

Portability: most pure SKILL.md procedures can travel across hosts that support Agent Skills. Adapt host-specific tools, paths, plugins, permissions and MCP configuration.

Agent Skills open standard · agentskills.io ↗

GitHub Copilot host guidance · docs.github.com ↗

Model Context Protocol

The open protocol for connecting agents to live tools.

Model Context Protocol

The open protocol that lets agents connect to live tools and data.

Architecture & Dataverse guidance

Well-Architected review and Dataverse tool selection.

Power Platform Well-Architected

Microsoft Learn guidance for evaluating solution design across the five pillars.

Dataverse tool selection

When to use MCP, the Dataverse CLI, the Python SDK or PAC for Dataverse work.

Dataverse Skills · reference · Operate

Microsoft Agent Framework

Framework guidance for agents and multi-agent workflows—not an Agent Skill.

Microsoft Learn · microsoft/agent-framework ↗

Build → Review pairings

Capture expertise	Skill Recorder	→ Review/edit generated SKILL.md	Portable procedure	Agent Skill	→ Host smoke test
Live integration	MCP server/plugin	→ Permissions + auth validation	Copilot Studio agent	mcs-assistant	→ PAC validation + human review

Daily decision rule

Treat plugins and MCP as integrations: verify the host, tools, authentication, permissions, and extension semantics every time.

Advisor catalog counts are unchanged. External gallery and additional standard/framework links are supporting resources, not additional catalog entries.

Agent Skills ↗ GitHub Copilot skills ↗ Skill Recorder ↗ Copilot Studio plugin ↗